STAFF GUIDE · ASSEMBLYMEMBER JESSE GABRIEL PRESS COVERAGE

Updating the tracker with the Update station

How to find new stories about Jesse Gabriel and save them into the PC tracker, from start to finish.

How the job works

New stories reach the tracker in a loop between your PC and a page on claude.ai called the **Update station**. The PC tells the station what the tracker already has; the station searches for what is new and hands back one zip file; the PC checks it and saves it. The station has its own Step 1, Step 2 and Step 3; this guide uses those names, and names the PC parts by where they are.

Part	Where	What happens	Page
Make the “for Update” file	PC tracker	A small file listing the stories the tracker already has. Make a new one after every save.	3
Step 1: load the file	Update station	The station reads what the tracker already has, and works out from which date to search.	4
Step 2: Update	Update station	Searches the web for new stories. About 25 minutes.	6
Also: add PDFs (optional)	Update station	NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, for stories the web search can’t reach. (For NewsBank, see the separate NewsBank Download Guide.)	9
Step 3: download the update folder	Update station	One .zip file with everything found.	10
Bring in update and Save	PC tracker	The tracker shows what it would change; you press Save.	11
Make refresh files	PC tracker	So your colleagues’ copies match yours.	15

The screenshots come from several test runs, so the numbers and file codes differ from picture to picture. On your own screen, the code in the update folder’s name should match the code in your “for Update” file’s name.

Words used in this guide

Word	What it means
Claude	The AI assistant (made by Anthropic) that reads each search result, keeps the real stories and rates them.
TinyFish	The web-search service the station uses to find new stories.
“for Update” file	A small file the PC tracker makes that lists the stories it already has. It holds no article text.
Update folder	The .zip file the station gives you. (A .zip is one file that holds many files.)
Update station	A page on claude.ai that does the searching. It has three steps, called Step 1, Step 2 and Step 3 on the page.
Refresh file	A .zip the keeper makes after a save, so colleagues’ copies match.
Keeper	The one person who saves updates (currently Sammy).
Fingerprint	A short code worked out from the workbook’s exact contents, like `41315fe0`. It changes whenever the workbook changes.

BEFORE YOU START

Before you start

1. **Use the keeper copy** of the PC tracker. Only the keeper saves updates. (The companion guide, *Using the AJG Press Tracker*, explains keeper and reader copies.)
2. **Close Excel** if the workbook is open.
3. **Have the Update station link ready:**

   Open the Update station

   https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL
   The station runs under the office’s claude.ai account, **ajgdistrict@gmail.com**. New link (if the station moves): _____
4. **The first time, allow Claude and TinyFish for the station page.** Claude: in the page’s Permissions menu, allow it, including sending pictures (it reads newspaper pages). TinyFish: it must be connected in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors) under the name exactly “TinyFish”, and allowed for the page. If either is missing, the station says so in red when you start.

Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC

The Update station never changes your workbook. It only makes a zip file. The PC tracker shows you everything in the zip before it saves, and backs up the workbook first.

THE STATION KEEPS NOTHING

It forgets everything when you close or reload the tab. Download the update folder (Step 3) before you close the tab.

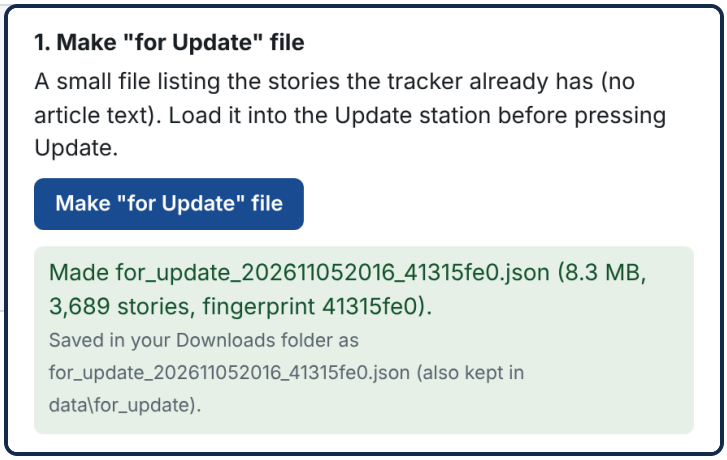
ON THE PC

Make the “for Update” file

1. Start the tracker (double-click `Start Tracker.cmd`).
2. Click **Tracker files** at the top right.
3. Under **1. Make “for Update” file**, click the button. It takes about a minute.
4. The file downloads to your Downloads folder, named like `for_update_202611052016_41315fe0.json`: the year, month, day, hour and minute it was made (2026-11-05, 8:16 PM), then the workbook’s fingerprint.

MAKE A NEW ONE AFTER EVERY SAVE

The file lists the stories the tracker has right now. A file made before a save doesn’t know about the stories that save added, so the station would find them again. The file is not stored online.

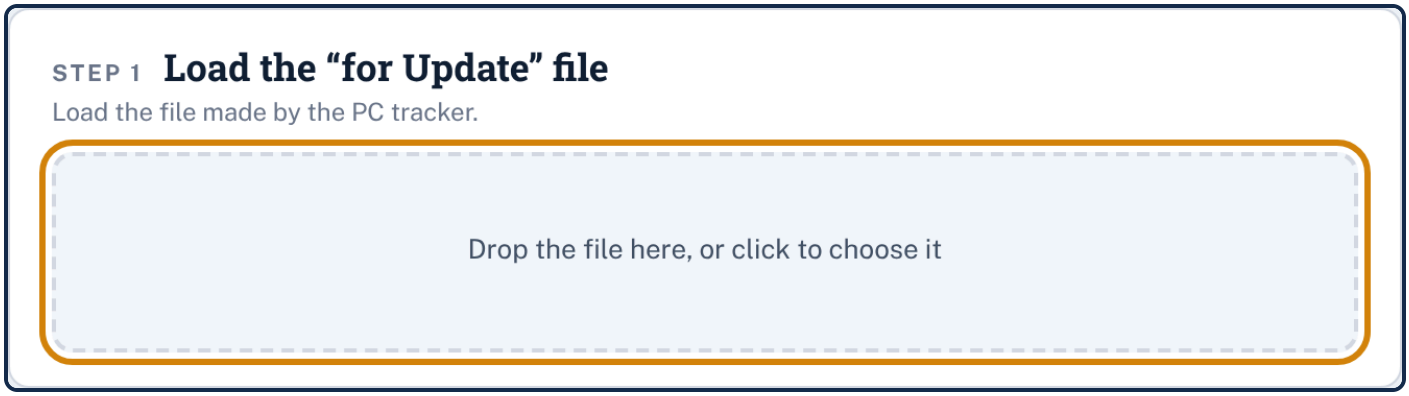


The file was made and downloaded.

IN THE STATION · STEP 1

Open the station and load the file

1. Open the Update station in your browser: https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL. If it asks you to sign in, sign in to claude.ai with ajgdistrict@gmail.com.
2. In **Step 1**, drop the “for Update” file on the dashed box, or click the box and choose the file.
3. Check what the station read from it (next page).

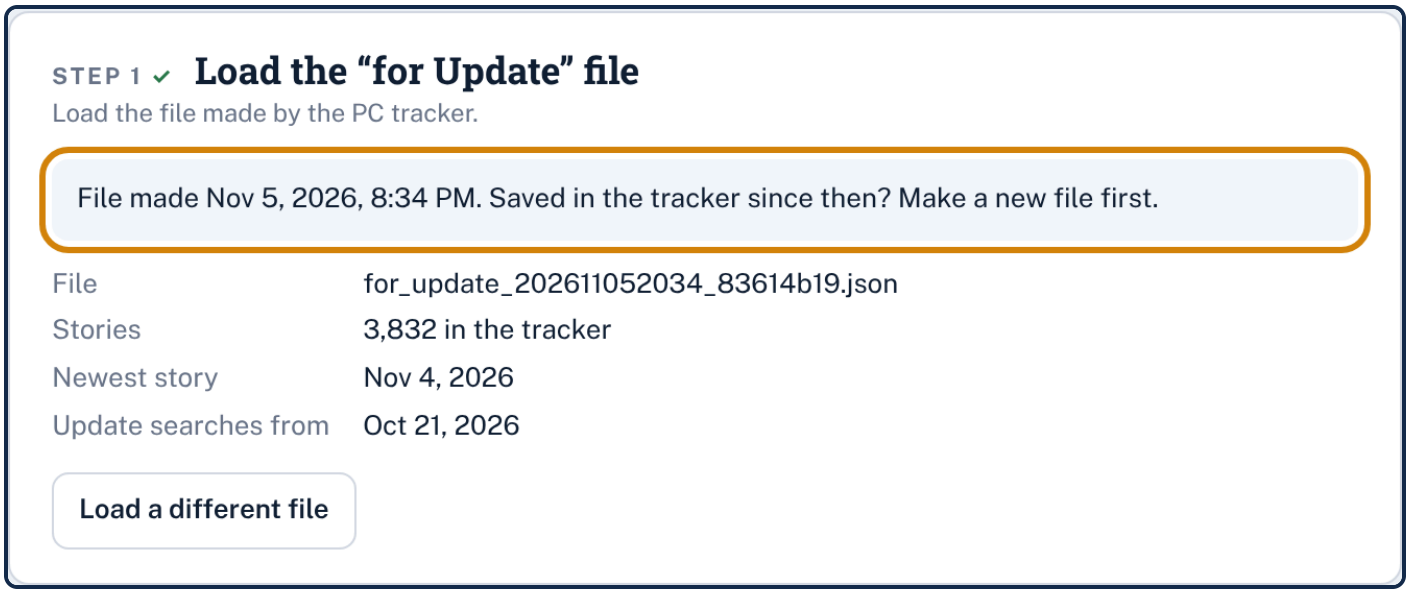


Step 1 before a file is loaded: drop the file in the outlined box.

The station is one long page: Step 1, Step 2, the NewsBank and ProQuest boxes, then Step 3. It never changes anything on your PC.

IN THE STATION · STEP 1, CONTINUED

What Step 1 shows



Step 1 after loading the file.

- **The gray line** says when the file was made: “Saved in the tracker since then? Make a new file first.” If you saved after making the file, stop and make a new “for Update” file. The line turns red when the file is more than a week old.
- **Load a different file** clears the page, including anything found and not yet downloaded. It asks you to click again to confirm. Closing or reloading the tab does the same, without asking.
- **Stories** is how many stories the tracker has.
- **Newest story** is the date of the newest story in the tracker.
- **Update searches from** is two weeks before that date. **There is no date to pick.** The station works it out. The two weeks of overlap catch stories that reach the web late. Stories the tracker already has are left out.

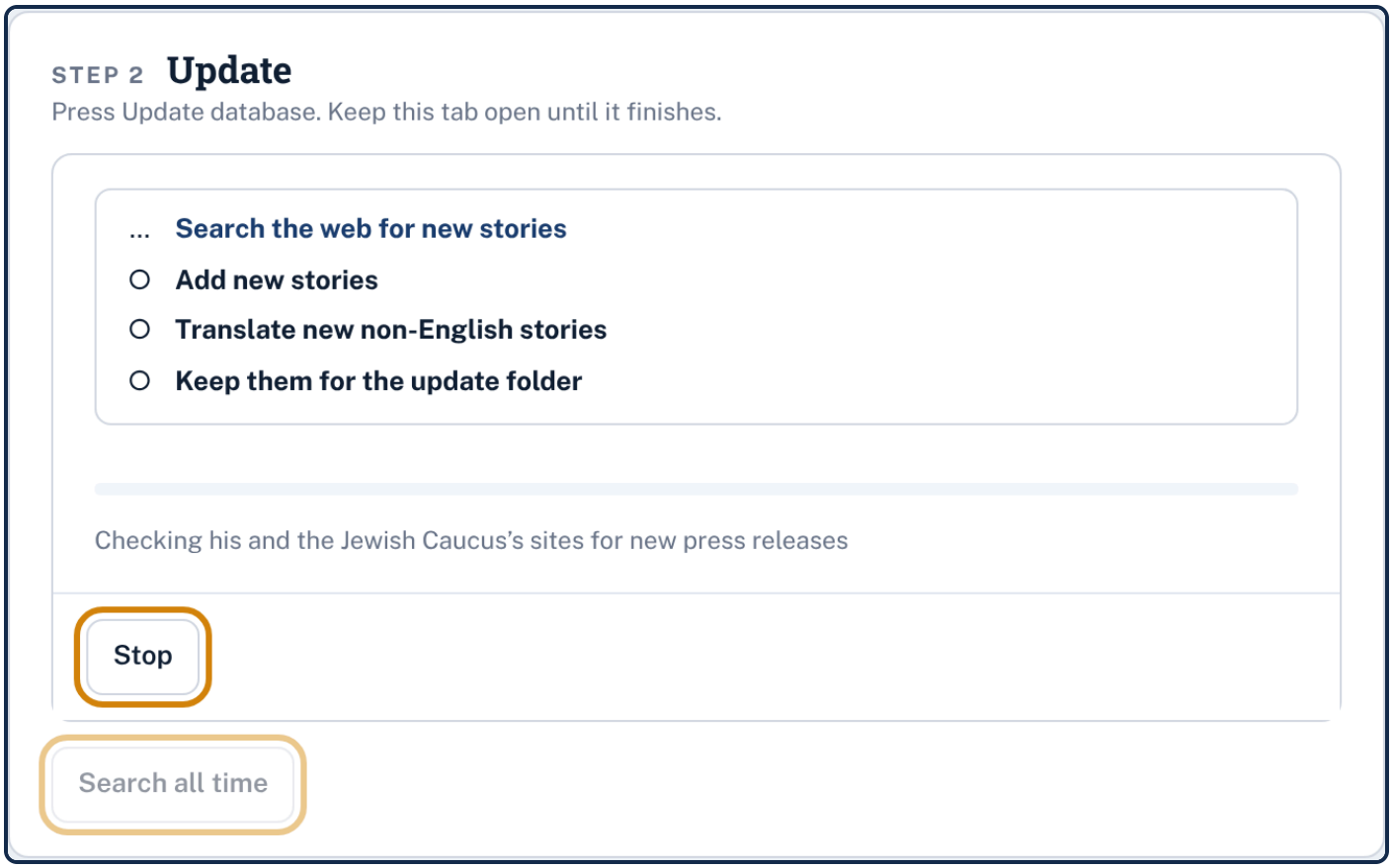
The top of the station has two buttons. **How it works** opens the station’s own short explanation (what each step does, NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, Automatic mode, and what to do if something is blocked). It is kept up to date with the station, so read it if this guide and the page ever differ. **Update database** asks you to confirm, then starts the search, the same as the button in Step 2.



The top of the station: How it works (left) and Update database (right).

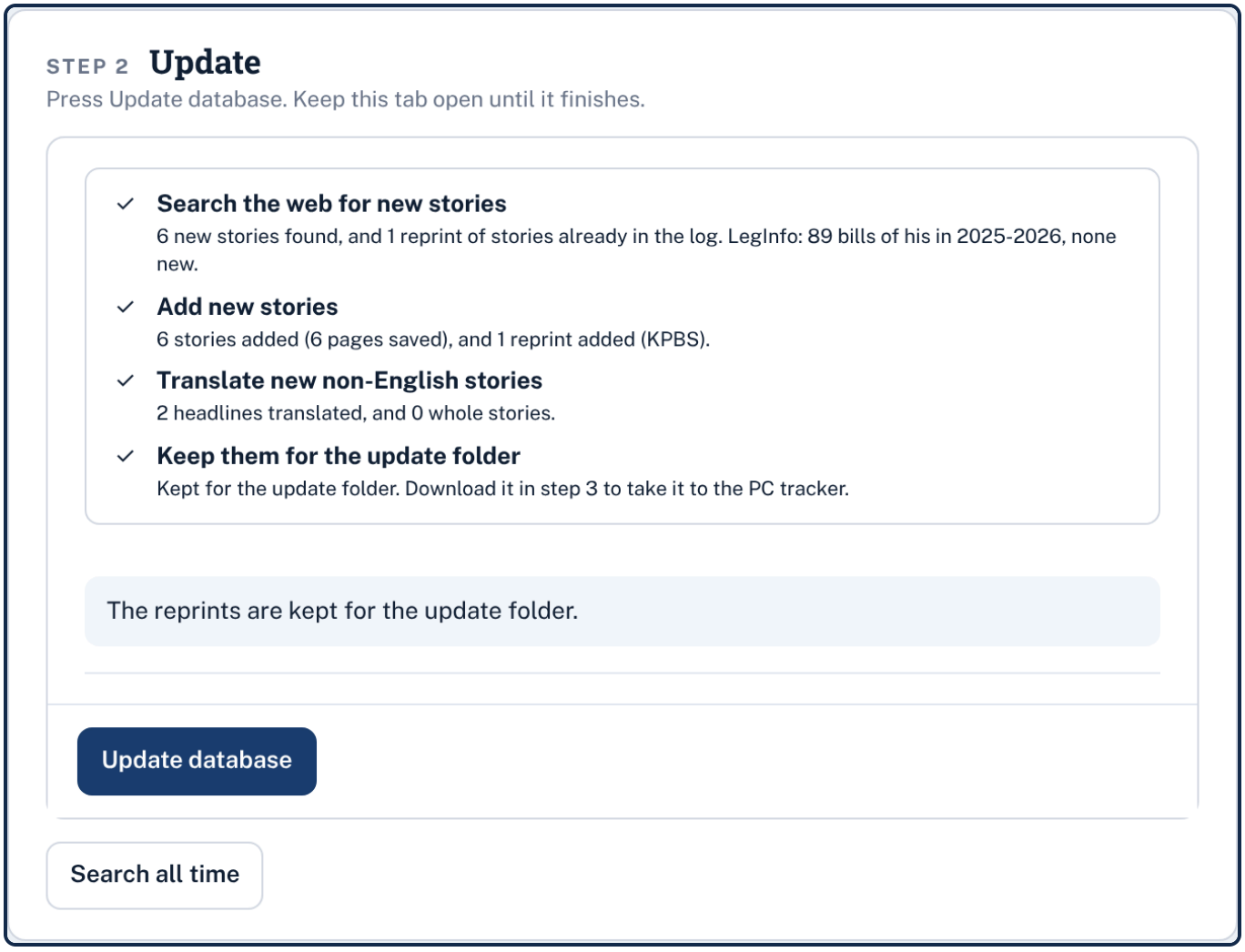
Press Update database

1. In **Step 2: Update**, press **Update database**. It starts at once. (The **Update database** button at the top of the page first asks “Update the database?”; press **Update** in that box.)
2. **Keep the station tab open and visible** until it finishes. It takes about 25 minutes. Browsers slow down hidden tabs, which can stall the run, so don’t minimise the window or switch to another tab in it, and keep the computer awake. Other programs beside it are fine.
3. Watch the checklist. Each line gets a check mark when it is done: search the web, add new stories, translate non-English stories, keep them for the update folder. While it runs, a **Stop** button under the checklist ends the run early.



While it runs: the line in blue is the one being worked on. Stop ends the run early. Search all time is grayed out until the run is over.

When the run is done



A finished run (example numbers). Each line says what it found. The line below the checklist says what happens to the rest.

What the search does for you

- Claude, the AI, reads every result and keeps only real news stories that name Assemblymember Gabriel. It leaves out press releases, social posts, YouTube, blogs, listing pages, music and board pages, and other people named Gabriel.
- It fills in each story's issue, bills, format, reach and tone.
- **A story the tracker already has is left out**, even when the tracker's copy came from NewsBank and has no web link.
- **A copy of a known story at another outlet is added as a reprint** of it.
- A web find dated more than a month before the search start is left out (not in Search all time). So is a reprint with no date of an older story. A row with no date takes the date in its web address when it has one.

- Every left-out row, with its reason, is kept in the update folder's record of the run. The PC preview does not list them.
- Stories not in English get an English headline now. The whole story is translated into English when you download the folder (page 10).

IF A NEWSBANK REFRESH IS DUE

One short line appears in Step 2: "A NewsBank refresh is due: add new NewsBank PDFs below." It is only a reminder. See page 9.

IF THE RUN ENDS EARLY

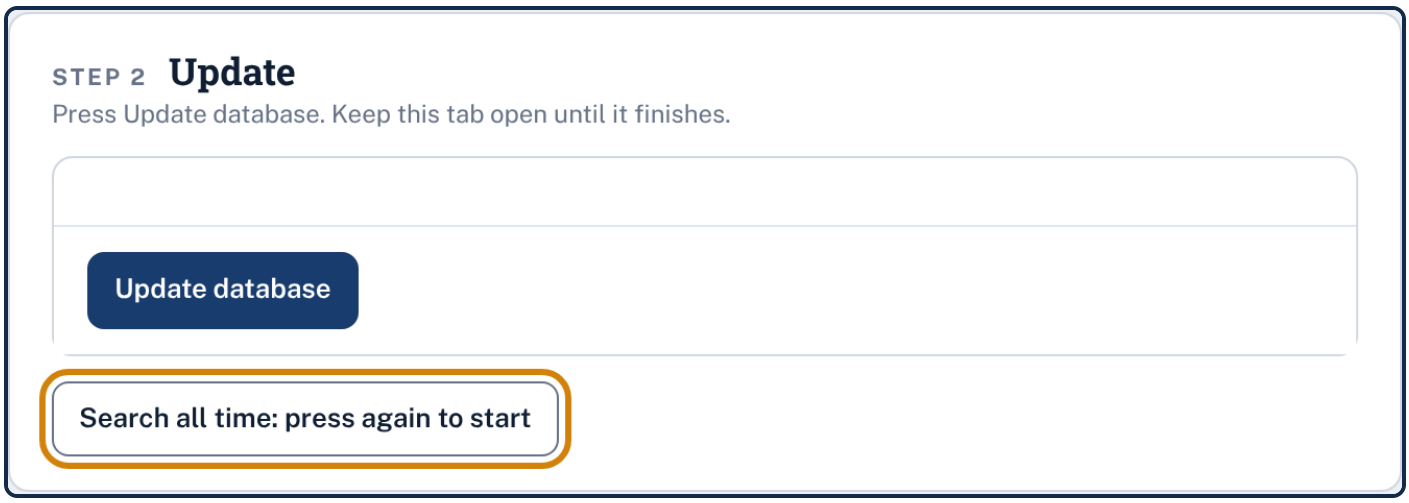
A red note says so. It does not mean "nothing new". Press Update database again, or download what it found and run it again another time.

STEP 2, OPTIONAL

Search all time

The normal Update looks only at the weeks since the newest story. **Search all time**, under the Update database button, runs the same searches **with no date limit**. Use it now and then to catch older stories the tracker never had. It takes longer and uses more searches. Stories the tracker already has are left out, as always.

1. Press **Search all time**. The button changes to "Search all time: press again to start".
2. Press it **again** within about 6 seconds to start. If you wait longer, it goes back to normal and nothing starts. This is so it isn't started by accident.
3. Keep the tab open until it finishes, as with a normal Update. While it runs the button reads "Searching all time…". Its results go into the same Step 3 folder.
4. Afterwards the button turns itself off. The next Update database is a normal one again.



After the first press, the button asks for a second press.

IN THE STATION · OPTIONAL

Add NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs

About 1 in 6 stories (print, wire stories, paywalled papers) can't be found on the web. About once a month, and soon after big events like the budget vote, add them from NewsBank. ProQuest PDFs work the same way in their own box.

1. **Download the PDFs** by following the **NewsBank Download Guide** (a separate printed guide): the State Library sign-in, the saved search, Sort by Oldest, and one PDF per page of results with APA citations. It says to start one week before the newest story in the tracker; the station shows that date in Step 1 as **Newest story**.
2. **Drop the PDFs** on the box **Add NewsBank PDFs and newspaper pages** (or **Add ProQuest PDFs**). You can drop many at once. A PDF can hold any number of stories.
3. With **Automatic mode** on (the box in Step 3; it is on unless you switched it off, and the station remembers your choice in that browser), they are added by themselves. If it is off, check the list and press **Add to the update**.

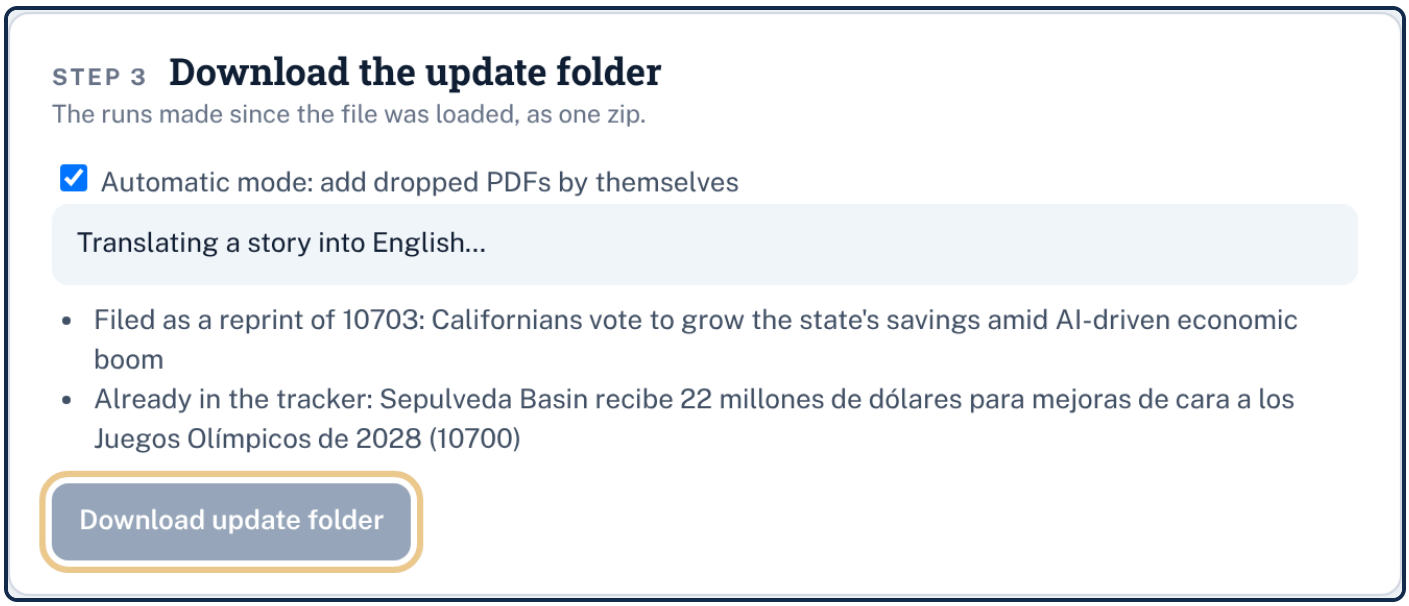


The NewsBank box. It also takes a picture or PDF of any newspaper page. "Add to the update" wakes up once a PDF is dropped. The ProQuest box below it looks the same.

- The station splits each NewsBank PDF into one PDF per story and skips stories the tracker already has.
- A NewsBank "Full Page" is a picture of a newspaper page. Claude reads it and adds the article about him to the right story, or as a new story. A page it can't place goes to the workbook's **Unlinked print pages** tab.
- If a run is going, the PDFs wait for it with Automatic mode on. With it off, press **Add to the update** again when the run is done.

Download the update folder

1. When the run (and any PDFs) are done, **Step 3** says what is ready, for example “Ready: 1 run: 6 new stories, 1 reprint”. Lines such as “Filed as a reprint of 10703: …” name finds the station filed under a story the tracker already has (10703 is that story’s Article ID). “Already in the tracker: …” names a find it left out.
2. Press **Download update folder**.
3. **Wait.** If there are stories in other languages, the status line first says “Translating story 1 of 2 into English…” (or “Translating a story into English…” for one). Each one gets a full English translation. This can take a few minutes. Then the folder is made and downloads.
4. It saves one .zip to your Downloads folder, named like `ajg_update_20261105-2021_83614b19.zip` (the date and time, then the workbook’s fingerprint). If your browser asks, confirm the save. Afterwards Step 3 says the folder was downloaded and offers **Download the last one again**, in case the file went missing.
5. If you add more after downloading, download again. The new folder has everything and replaces the old one; its name ends in `_v2`. Bring in only the newest one.
6. **Don’t unzip it.** The PC tracker takes the .zip file itself.

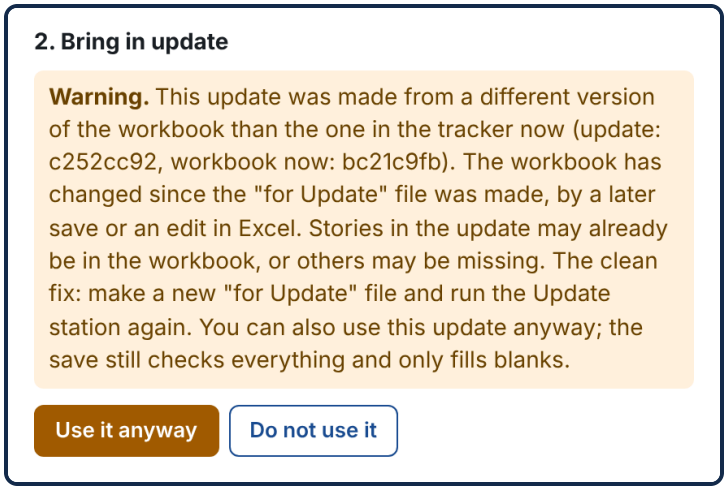


While a non-English story is translated. The button stays grayed out until the folder is made.

ON THE PC

Bring in the update

1. Close Excel. In the tracker, click **Tracker files**.
2. Drop the update zip on the dashed box under **2. Bring in update**, or click **choose a file**.
3. Wait. The tracker checks the update. Nothing is saved yet. It can take a few minutes.
4. **If a yellow warning appears**, the workbook changed after you made the “for Update” file, so stories in the update may already be in the workbook, or others may be missing. **The clean fix:** press **Do not use it**, make a new “for Update” file and run the station again. Only if you cannot rerun, and the only change was your own edit, press **Use it anyway**: the save still checks everything and only fills blanks, but read the preview carefully for stories the workbook already has.
5. Read the preview (next page), then press **Save** at its end, or **Do not use this update**.



The warning for an update made from an older workbook: Use it anyway, or Do not use it.

ON THE PC, CONTINUED

Read the preview

- **The bold line** sums up what Save would do: rows added, cells filled, rows moved, reprints and items to check.
- The tracker compares the article texts to make the final call on what is a reprint, and gives the new files their final numbers. The preview lists every change.
- “Cells where the update disagrees with the workbook (the workbook keeps its value)” are cells where the update had a different value; the save kept the workbook’s and left them for the keeper to look at.

2. Bring in update

If you press Save: 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

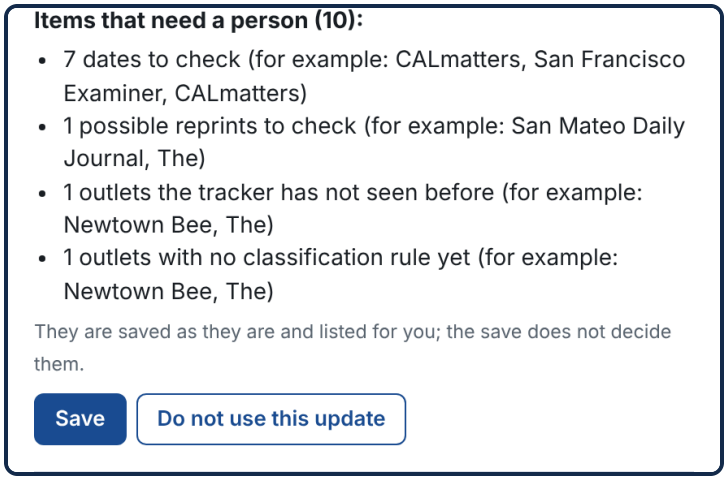
You chose to use an update made from an older workbook. The save still runs all its checks.

- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1 story removed (s01888)
- 21 rows added to the Coverage tab
- 10 rows added to the Originals tab
- 1 row added to the Removed tab
- 2 rows added to the Unlinked print pages tab
- 4 reprint counts updated
- 2 cells of removed stories' rows moved to the Removed tab
- 2 press-release cells recalculated
- 25 saved pages added to the library
- 1 file of removed stories moved aside (not deleted)

The top of the preview: what Save would do. (A long list of renamed files under it is left out here.)

Items that need a person, then Save

Items that need a person are things the save does not decide for you. **The save writes them as they are** and lists them. Each line names the kind of item, with examples:



The end of the preview: items that need a person, then Save.

Item	What it means
Cells where the update disagrees with the workbook	The update had a different value; the workbook kept its own.
Dates to check	The save could not confirm the story's date. Check it against the story.
Possible reprints to check	The story may be a copy of one the tracker already has.
Outlets not seen before / with no classification rule	A new outlet; its reach and type may need setting.
Other kinds	The line says in plain words what it is, for example stories where it is unclear they are about the Assemblymember.

Nothing needs doing before you press Save. Afterwards, check those rows in the workbook (the same items are listed again in the result after the save). If a filled value is wrong, the keeper fixes it in Excel and then uses Tracker files, Repairs, "Accept the workbook as it is now".

1. Press **Save**, or **Do not use this update** to drop it.
2. Keep the black command window (the one the tracker opened) open. The tracker backs up the workbook, writes, then reloads the page by itself.

After the save

The new stories are now in the tracker. The line at the top of the page says “Last updated” with today’s date, and the Update log in Manage lists the update with everything it added.

NEXT TIME, A NEW “FOR UPDATE” FILE

The save changed the workbook. Before the next station run, make a new “for Update” file.

2. Bring in update

Saved. 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

- Backup of the old workbook: AJG Coverage - NewsBank BACKUP before run run-mw3o2qv2rzz 2026-11-05 1213.xlsx

After Save: the result and the backup it made.

- 1 edit saved and set aside in the tracker (db_applied\edits, not deleted)
- The tracker page was rebuilt with the new stories
- 10 items are listed for a person to look at (see the run notes)

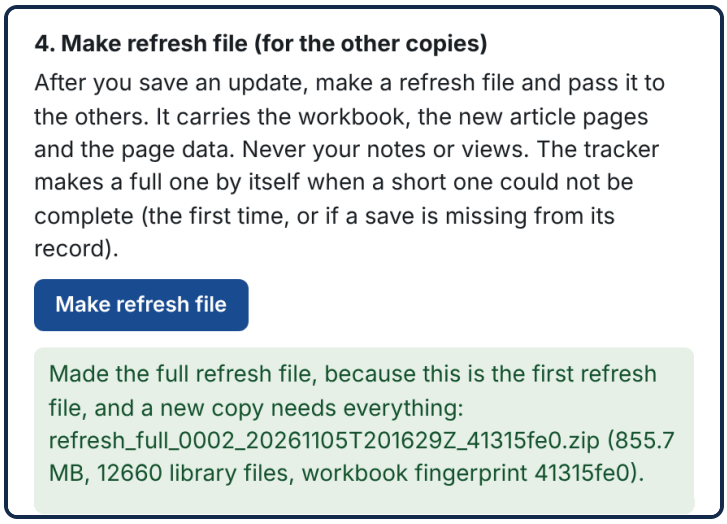
Reloading the tracker...

The end of the result. “db_applied\edits” is a folder inside data that you never need to open. The “items … listed for a person to look at” are the “Items that need a person” from the preview. (Two lines of this result, one with the new workbook fingerprint, are cut out of this picture.)

ON THE PC

Make refresh files for colleagues

1. In **Tracker files**, under **4. Make refresh file**, click **Make refresh file**.
2. It downloads to your Downloads folder.
3. Pass it on by the **shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick**. Don’t use email or Teams: the first refresh file carries the whole library and is hundreds of MB; later ones are smaller.
4. Each colleague closes Excel, opens their own tracker, clicks **Tracker files**, and drops the file on **Bring in refresh file**. Their notes and saved views stay as they are.



The refresh file was made: 855.7 MB, because it was the first one. The number after “full” in the file name is a running number the tracker keeps. Under this message the tracker also says where a copy is kept (data\refresh_out) and to pass the file on by the shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick; it can be too big for email or Teams.

Problems and fixes

What you see	What to do
The station page asks you to sign in	Sign in to claude.ai with ajgdistrict@gmail.com.
“Claude is not allowed on this page”	Allow Claude for the station page in the Permissions menu, including sending pictures, then reload the page.
Red note: “Stopped. TinyFish is not connected on this account. In claude.ai open Settings, Connectors, connect TinyFish, then reload this page.” (or “The TinyFish connection has lapsed. Reconnect TinyFish…”)	Connect or reconnect TinyFish in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors), allow it for the station page, reload the page, load the file and press Update database again.
“File made … Saved in the tracker since then? Make a new file first.”	It is a reminder, not an error. If you saved in the tracker after making the file, make a new “for Update” file and load that one. Otherwise the update finds that save’s stories again.
Stories you already saved show up again in the preview	The “for Update” file was made before that save. Make a new file, load it, and run the station again.
“Search all time” did nothing	It needs a second press within about 6 seconds of the first (the button says “press again to start”). It is grayed out while a run is going.
“A NewsBank refresh is due”	A reminder only. Add new NewsBank PDFs when you can (page 9). Nothing is blocked.
Download seems stuck on “Translating story … into English…”	It is translating the whole story, one at a time. Wait; keep the tab open. If one can’t be translated, the folder still downloads, and a line under the button says which story keeps only its English headline and summary.
A red note says the run ended early	It does not mean nothing new. Run Update database again.
You closed or reloaded the station tab	The run stops, and anything it found but you had not downloaded is gone. Load the “for Update” file again and press Update database again.
You added PDFs after downloading	Download again. Bring in only the newest zip (the one ending _v2, _v3 …).
The PC warns the update was made from a different workbook	The clean fix: press Do not use it, make a new “for Update” file and run the station again. Use it anyway only if you cannot rerun and the only change was your own edit.

What you see	What to do
The PC says the update was already saved	You brought in a zip that was saved before. Nothing is added twice. Use the newest zip, or make a new “for Update” file and run again.
Save is grayed out	Close Excel, and wait for any other save to finish. If the workbook was changed in Excel, use Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”.
“That is not a .zip file”	Drop the .zip itself, not an unzipped folder.

CHEAT SHEET

Start to finish

On the PC

1. Tracker files → **Make “for Update” file** (p. 3).
2. When the zip is downloaded: Tracker files → **Bring in update** → drop the zip (p. 11).
3. Read the preview and the items that need a person → **Save**.
4. **Make refresh file** → shared drive, OneDrive or USB (p. 15).

In the Update station (its Steps 1–3)

1. Step 1: drop the “for Update” file; check **Newest story** and **Update searches from** (p. 4).
2. Step 2: **Update database**. Keep the tab open, about 25 minutes (p. 6). **Search all time** (press twice) now and then (p. 8).
3. Also, optional: drop NewsBank / ProQuest PDFs (p. 9).
4. Step 3: **Download update folder**; wait for any translations (p. 10).

REMEMBER

Make a new “for Update” file after every save. Bring in only the newest zip. Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC.